Westbrook Planning Board

~ Planning Board Meeting ~

Date: Tuesday, March 3, 2026
Time: 7:00 PM
Location: Westbrook High School (Room 114), 125 Stroudwater St. (Hybrid via Zoom)
Video: https://vimeo.com/1170112858
Packet: https://www.westbrookmaine.gov/AgendaCenter/ViewFile/Agenda/_03032026-990

Timestamps below are clickable [0:00]-style links — they jump straight to that moment in the video.

This summary highlights the meeting's key discussions and decisions, with direct quotes and timestamps for verification — it is not a substitute for watching the full meeting. *Summarization necessarily condenses and selects; for complete context, nuance, and anything not covered here, watch the full video at the link above. (Produced by: WestbrookCurrents.com)*

I. Roll Call

Roll Call [0:20]

Discussion Summary

Chair Larry McWilliams called the meeting to order. Roll call: seven of nine seated members present (McWilliams, Vice Chair John Turcotte, Lucas Schrage, Oriana Farnham, Robin Tannenbaum, Kevin Price, and Nancy Litrocapes); Jason Frazier and Karen Axelson absent. No minutes were on the agenda for approval.

Key Decisions

✓ **Quorum established.**

Action Items

None.

Orders of the Day

26-000056 — Site Plan — 70 Scott Drive, Prompto Oil Change [1:43]

Discussion Summary

Barry Geyer (Jones & Beach Engineers), with Kevin King and Mike Harrison of Prompto, presented the same 50′×50′ warehouse addition to Building B (including a 12,000-gallon tank farm) and expanded parking reviewed at the February 3 workshop. Impervious coverage increases from 42.5% to 48.1% (well under the 80% zoning maximum), mitigated by a planned rain garden; the applicant confirmed all outstanding staff comments from the prior meeting have been addressed. No public comment, no board questions.

Key Decisions

✓ **Approved unanimously by roll call, 7–0 (moved by Kevin Price, seconded by John Turcotte).**

Action Items

None.

26-000067 — Land Use Ordinance Amendment — Child Care Definitions [6:07]

Discussion Summary

City Planner Rebecca Spitella recapped the amendment first workshopped February 3: it raises the number of unrelated children a home daycare provider may care for before requiring state licensing (from two to three, or four with a sibling set), and adds flexibility for play-area location and on-street parking use where the standard requirement isn't practical. Members Oriana Farnham and John Turcotte both thanked staff for addressing workshop questions.

Member Nancy Litrocapes asked how the ordinance's requirement that a facility not burden on-site septic or off-site waste disposal is actually assessed. Spitella explained that code enforcement reviews documented septic sizing against plumbing-code requirements for the added capacity during permitting — since this use shifts from a conditional use requiring board review to a permitted use reviewed administratively by the code officer — and an upgrade could be required before approval if an existing system is undersized.

Key Decisions

✓ Recommended for approval unanimously by roll call, 7–0 (moved by Robin Tannenbaum, seconded by John Turcotte); as a Land Use Ordinance amendment, this proceeds toward City Council for final adoption.

Action Items

None.

Workshop (No Vote)

26-000106 — Conditional Use — 33 Elmwood Ave, Redeemer Church [13:30]

Discussion Summary

Pastor Joel Miller presented Redeemer Church's request for a Place of Worship conditional use in a 3,600-square-foot suite at 33 Elmwood Avenue, a building that also houses a restaurant/event space (formerly a bowling alley/entertainment venue) currently open only for private events. The church, currently meeting at the American Legion near Riverbank Park but limited to an early 8 AM slot due to other tenants there, hopes to move to a more accessible 10 AM service time and anticipates growth from roughly 25 current members; the open sanctuary floor plan could seat an estimated 100–150 depending on final fire/code occupancy limits, to be determined separately from tonight's land-use review. The build-out adds a small nursery room for childcare during services; the congregation does not plan to use the building's existing kitchen facilities.

Staff (Rebecca Spitella) confirmed ample on-site parking and that the property owner has consented to the sublease and application; since the restaurant use is currently limited to private events, staff does not anticipate a parking or scheduling conflict between the two uses. Board members asked about potential parking conflicts (addressed above), whether the kitchen would be used (no), and whether the landlord might eventually allow the church to expand into more of the building if the congregation outgrows the current suite; Pastor Miller said that conversation hasn't happened yet and the church sees this as a near-term rather than permanent home. Board members expressed enthusiasm about the building being reactivated for community use.

Key Decisions

✓ No vote — workshop item; expected to return for formal conditional-use approval once the floor plan and occupancy details are finalized with Code Enforcement and the Fire Department.

Action Items

None.

How this was made

This summary was produced from the meeting video (linked above, hosted on the City's Vimeo showcase). The audio was downloaded with Downie 4 and transcribed with speaker diarization using MacWhisper. Claude (Anthropic's AI) cross-checked names against the official Planning Board roster, attributed speakers from context (introductions, roll-call order, direct address by the Chair) rather than the raw diarization labels alone, and drafted this summary and the quoted excerpts. Quotes are lightly cleaned of filler words/false starts but not reworded. Review tier: Not reviewed.

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